DAVID RACCUGLIA

Founder, American Crew | REUZEL co-founder | Global grooming entrepreneur and educator

David Raccuglia is a trained barber, salon owner and entrepreneur who founded American Crew in Chicago in 1994, helping establish modern professional men's grooming as a distinct global category.

Achievements

- Founded American Crew and built a brand with more than three decades of industry heritage.
- Appointed American Crew Creative Director and Global Head of Education in 2022, with responsibility for global education and creative direction.
- Named among REUZEL's co-founders, alongside Rob Wilcox, Laurence Hegarty, Leen Bergmann and Bertus/Robert-Jan Rietveld.
- Established an additional career as a photographer and filmmaker, with portraits including Jack Nicholson, Ray Charles, James Brown and Yoko Ono.

Connections and network depth

- **US:** Longstanding professional relationships through American Crew, salon ownership, barber education and the Revlon Professional organisation.
- **International:** American Crew reported distribution through over 30,000 salons, barbershops and authorised retailers across 50 countries in its October 2022 announcement. This measures brand reach, rather than David's personal contact list.
- **Industry connections:** REUZEL's founding team; American Crew's creative, education and commercial community; salon and barber professionals. His career also includes Vidal Sassoon and Jingles, and co-founding Art & Science with Laurence Hegarty.
- **Beyond grooming:** An established creative career spanning photography, publishing and documentary production.

Potential value to Barber Republic

Industry credibility, insight into barber education and standards, and potential introductions to experienced educators, shop owners and international grooming leaders.

Slide takeaway: Founder of American Crew, bringing decades of professional grooming experience and international industry relationships.

ROB WILCOX

CEO & Co-founder, REUZEL | Professional grooming brand and distribution executive

Rob Wilcox is the Denver-based CEO and co-founder of REUZEL, the international grooming brand born from Rotterdam's Schorem barbering community. His career combines professional beauty marketing, brand development and international distribution.

Achievements

- Co-founded REUZEL with David Raccuglia, Laurence Hegarty, Leen Bergmann and Bertus/Robert-Jan Rietveld, helping develop an internationally recognised professional grooming brand.
- Previously served as Senior Vice President of Marketing at American Crew, according to his published career profile.
- Founded Freshsqueezed, following earlier marketing and education work at Graham Webb, according to that profile.
- REUZEL's commercial development includes professional wholesale channels, barber education and a 2024 product collaboration with Liquid Death.

Connections and network depth

- **US:** Relationships through REUZEL's professional distribution, wholesale, barbershop and salon channels, complemented by earlier American Crew experience.
- **7,000+ US doors:** Rob has told Johnny Shanahan that he can access over 7,000 US doors. This is founder-reported information from their discussions; it is not independently verified or committed Barber Republic distribution.
- **International:** REUZEL has documented channels in the US, UK and continental Europe, plus an announced exclusive distributor for Australia and New Zealand. A published profile attributes a 95+ country footprint to Rob; obtain his confirmation before presenting that number as a verified deck statistic.
- **Industry connections:** David Raccuglia, Laurence Hegarty, Leen Bergmann and Bertus/Robert-Jan Rietveld, plus REUZEL's commercial, distribution and education community.
- **Beyond grooming:** REUZEL's Liquid Death collaboration demonstrates the brand's ability to work across consumer categories; it does not establish personal access to every executive involved.

Potential value to Barber Republic

US market-entry guidance, distributor introductions, brand positioning and potential routes to recruit shops and barbers through established professional channels.

Slide takeaway: REUZEL's CEO and co-founder, bringing international brand-building experience and a potential route to thousands of US industry doors.

Presentation notes

- Johnny reports that both men expressed clear commitment and enthusiasm in recent discussions. Use the precise agreed description of their Barber Republic involvement; no formal title is assigned in these profiles.
- Personal involvement does not itself constitute endorsement or distribution commitments by American Crew, Revlon or REUZEL.
- Brand distribution measures market reach, not the size of an individual's directly accessible network or guaranteed adoption.
- American Crew's 30,000+/50-country statistic is dated October 2022. REUZEL's 95+ country figure requires direct confirmation; the 7,000+ US doors figure is attributed to Rob's conversation with Johnny.

Sources

1. American Crew, About: Open source
2. American Crew announcement, 13 October 2022, reproduced by citybiz: Open source
3. David Raccuglia, official biography: Open source
4. Modern Salon, career interview: Open source
5. Glossy, REUZEL founding team and Liquid Death collaboration, 2024: Open source
6. BarberX, first-hand identification of Rob as REUZEL CEO/co-founder: Open source
7. Rob Wilcox published career profile (secondary aggregator; career dates and country count require confirmation): Open source
8. Rob's professional profile: Open source
9. REUZEL professional wholesale: Open source
10. REUZEL Europe wholesale: Open source
11. Hairco Australia distributor announcement: Open source